

The next horizon: recommended actions for harnessing growth

In this dynamic environment, workforce benefits stakeholders must carefully identify immediate-term priorities considering the inevitable waves of changes to come. Future evolutions will shape the benefits employers offer, how they engage and educate employees so they find the right benefits, and the connections to partners and other stakeholders in the ecosystem. The one constant is the critical importance of benefits in attracting and retaining the talent all types of organizations need to succeed.

To unlock growth, workforce benefits executives should consider the following key actions as they look to the next horizon:

- **Enhance relevance:** Adopt holistic solutions, curated benefits programs and AI tools for hyper-personalization to move beyond one-size-fits-all offerings.
- **Create next-generation offerings:** Explore changes in product design and eligibility and experiment with purpose-built marketplaces to connect freelance workers to the benefits they want.
- **Prepare for generational shifts:** Define generational bundles, flexible features and connected experiences to satisfy different cohorts with diverse needs.
- **Expand channels:** Engage brokers that add value by providing strategic insights, pointing out new distribution channels and making connections to strategic growth partners.
- **Build confidence with absence and leave management:** Experiment with and proactively design new approaches to the administration of absence and leave management benefits with a focus on integrated experiences and leave type expansions.
- **Accelerate digitization and AI adoption:** Continue to leverage AI/agentic AI to redefine processes and experiences, prioritize claims and enrollment, and look to disrupt learning and development.